

This code is equivalent to the following *shortestWithBaseCase.html* program:

JavaScript

```
<script type="text/javascript">
function shortestWithBaseCase(makeRecursiveCall) {
    document.write("shortestWithBaseCase(" + makeRecursiveCall +
        ") called.<br />");
    if (makeRecursiveCall === false) {
        // BASE CASE
        document.write("Returning from base case.<br />");
        ❶ return;
    } else {
        // RECURSIVE CASE
        ❷ shortestWithBaseCase(false);
        document.write("Returning from recursive case.<br />");
        return;
    }
}

document.write("Calling shortestWithBaseCase(false):<br />");
❸ shortestWithBaseCase(false);
document.write("<br />");
document.write("Calling shortestWithBaseCase(true):<br />");
❹ shortestWithBaseCase(true);
</script>
```

When you run this code, the output looks like this:

```
Calling shortestWithBaseCase(False):
shortestWithBaseCase(False) called.
Returning from base case.
```

```
Calling shortestWithBaseCase(True):
shortestWithBaseCase(True) called.
shortestWithBaseCase(False) called.
Returning from base case.
Returning from recursive case.
```

This function doesn't do anything useful except provide a short example of recursion (and it could be made shorter by removing the text output, but the text is useful for our explanation). When `shortestWithBaseCase(False)` is